Floats in Python

BEGINNER LESSON | Qspiders | Python 3

Learning goals: Recognize decimal numbers, use floats, and check their type.

1. What is a float?

A float is a number type commonly written with a decimal point. Use it for values such as prices, temperatures, or measurements. Python calls this type `float`.

2. Create and use

Write a decimal point between the whole-number and fractional parts.

```
price = 19.5
temperature = -2.5
print(price)        # Output: 19.5
print(temperature)  # Output: -2.5
```

3. Check the type

Use `type()` to find a value's data type.

```
print(type(price))  # Output: <class 'float'>
```

4. Key points

- `5.0` is a float, even though its value is a whole number.

- `5` is an integer; `5.0` is a float.

- `"19.5"` is text because it is inside quotes.

5. Try it yourself

Create `height` with the value `1.65`. Print its value and its type.